

involved. Second, we examined the myth that says wealthy people take crazy risks with their money, either with risky investments or stupid, get-rich-quick schemes. The research showed us that the millionaires in our study all built their wealth slowly and steadily with commonly available retirement accounts like the 401(k). Third, we answered the myth that wealthy people have a leg up in their education or careers. Rather than any unfair advantages, we found that the typical millionaire has a public or state school degree and a normal job with a normal salary. These myths are often used by people to excuse a lack of effort, to rationalize why they aren't winning with money. But these excuses don't hold any water. And now you know the truth: you can do better—no matter your background, income, or education—and, ultimately, you are the one with the power to accomplish your money goals.

Then we dug in our heels and examined five key character traits of the typical American millionaire. Television likes to portray these men and women as sleazy, dishonest, unreliable, narcissistic monsters, but we know better. We saw that the average millionaires in America take responsibility for themselves, their wealth, and their needs; they're intentional about what they're doing and where they want their lives to go; they set goals and keep those goals front and center until they achieve them; they work their butts off and know the dignity and honor in a good day's labor; and they stay consistent in the day-to-day, slow-and-steady progress toward their long-term goals. You may have had your doubts about millionaires and their character before, but now you know the reality. These aren't flashy, big-headed morons doing everything they can to show off their wealth; they're simple, humble, happy people who you'd never know were millionaires. Every single one of them earned and deserved their wealth, and they're using it responsibly, being blessings to their families and communities. So, please, let's stop portraying these hardworking Americans as stuffy, high-brow losers, living lavish lifestyles, okay? The research shows that's simply not true.

Now that you know who these everyday millionaires are, how they act, and how they smashed their wealth-building goals, let's tackle one more key issue. We've spent this entire book talking about, dreaming about, and working toward financial independence. We've seen how others have done it, what they look like, and how they act. It's time to turn the tables a little